Session 8: Your AI Strategy

Business Intelligence & AI

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The Course Journey

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Session 1
What AI Can Do for You — personal productivity with AI

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Session 2
Iterate, Critique, Trust — the maker/checker framework

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Session 3
AI Meets Your Data — enterprise data access

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From Data to Deliverable — reporting pipelines and the agent loop

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Session 5
What Does Deployment Look Like? — architecture, data security, build vs. buy

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Session 6
Can You Trust It? — validation, governance, guardrails

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Session 7
Let the Data Predict — predictive modeling with AI

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Today
Your AI Strategy — capstone and synthesis

Today’s Objective

Present a credible, scoped AI adoption strategy and leave with a concrete next step

The Setup

Your Audience

You are presenting to your executive team. Your breakout group is your board of advisors.

Convince them this is worth funding.

Capstone Format

1

Breakout Pitches

5 groups of 6. Each person gives a 2-minute pitch + 1 min feedback. Group votes on the strongest.

→

2

Plenary Presentations

5 winning strategies presented to the full class. 5 min each + 3 min Q&A from peers.

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3

Instructor Feedback

Feedback on pilot scope, business case, governance, and Day 1 action for each strategy.

What Makes a Strong Pitch

Evaluation Dimensions

- **Specificity** — a concrete use case, not “we’ll use AI for analytics”
- **Business case** — who benefits, what decision gets faster, what’s the dollar impact
- **Data readiness** — where does the data live, what’s the integration challenge
- **Governance** — who validates answers, what are the guardrails
- **Day 1 action** — what happens Monday morning, not “we’ll form a committee”

The best pitches are **narrow and actionable**. “We’ll deploy document AI on our 200 vendor contracts so procurement can answer compliance questions in seconds” beats “We’ll implement an enterprise AI strategy.”

Breakout Round

Breakout Instructions

Your Pitch (2 minutes)

- What’s the use case?
- What data or documents does it use?
- Who are the users and what decision does it improve?
- What’s your Day 1 action?

Your Feedback (1 minute)

- Is the scope tight enough to pilot in 30 days?
- What’s the biggest risk?
- What question would the CFO ask?
- Vote: which pitch should represent the group?

Plenary Presentations

Synthesis: What You Now Know

Personal Productivity Multiplier

AI is available right now — charts, documents, analyses, automated workflows. The tools from Sessions 1–2 require no IT approval and no enterprise deployment.

Plain English = Data Answers

AI agents turn natural language questions into enterprise data answers — replacing dashboards, manual reports, and the wait for analyst time.

Simple but Not Easy

The technology is simpler than expected (50 lines of code) but production requires governance, verification, and organizational readiness.

Three Complementary Tools

Database AI for structured data. Document AI for unstructured text. Predictive models for forecasting and classification. Together they cover the full spectrum of data-driven decisions.

The Critical Skill

Asking the right questions, iterating on output, and verifying the answers. The maker/checker mindset is the throughline of this entire course.

Beyond Data

AI as Thinking Partner

The real power isn’t asking what happened. It’s asking what should we do — and pushing back on the answer.

AI anchors on whatever framing you provide. The human role is challenging assumptions, not outsourcing judgment.

The Thinking Partner Demo

Data Question

"What were Q4 sales for the Energy Division?"

- One answer. One number.
- Useful, but limited.

Strategic Question

"I'm considering expanding the Energy Division. What are the top 3 risks based on our data?"

- Synthesizes across sales, headcount, customer concentration, margin trends
- Then: "Push back on risk #2 — what's the evidence?"

The shift from "report pulling" to "strategic dialogue" is where the real ROI lives. But remember: AI anchors on your framing. **Challenge its assumptions** the way you'd challenge a consultant.

Turn 1: The Strategic Question

> **“I’m considering expanding the Energy Division into the Southeast. Based on our pipeline, customer concentration, and support ticket trends, what are the top 3 risks?”**

The agent queried three systems (Legacy CRM, NetSuite Finance, Zendesk) and returned:

Risk 1 — Thin pipeline: Only 14 deals totaling $2.1M in Southeast regions. Division generates $147M annually — the pipeline is 1.4% of that base. Average deal size 28% below division average.

Risk 2 — Customer concentration: Top 5 customers = 62% of Energy revenue. ExxonMobil alone = 23%. Expansion funded from division profits is vulnerable to a single account loss.

Risk 3 — Support strain: Tickets up 34% YoY, resolution time up from 18 to 27 hours. Adding a region increases load on an already degraded support team.

Turns 2–3: Pushback and Evidence

> **Turn 2:** “You’re assuming our supply chain can handle Southeast volume. What if it can’t?”

The agent pulled Oracle SCM data it had not previously queried:

- Houston warehouse at **91% capacity** (pipes & fittings), lead times up **56% YoY**
- **3 of top 10 suppliers are single-source** (National Oilwell Varco at $4.5M/year)
- **Revised risk ranking:** Supply chain promoted to #1, displacing thin pipeline

> **Turn 3:** “Push back on risk #2. What’s the actual evidence?”

The agent separated its claims by **confidence level:**

- **High confidence:** Delivery Issues tickets +60%, resolution time nearly doubled — this is real operational strain
- **Medium confidence:** Ticket spike correlates with warehouse capacity data but causation is not proven
- **Lower confidence:** Assumed shared support pool with Safety Division — no data confirming this

Turn 2: the agent updated its analysis when challenged — it is not anchored to its first answer. Turn 3: it **decomposed its**

Turn 4: The Decision Boundary

“Given all of this, should we expand or not?”

Agent: “That’s not my decision to make — and you should be skeptical of any AI system that would make it for you.”

What Favors Expansion

- Strategic diversification (62% top-5 concentration is a vulnerability)
- Board alignment (Energy growth is a Horizon 1 priority)
- Organic demand exists (14 deals without dedicated BD effort)

What Argues Against Expanding Now

- Supply chain at 91% with 56% lead time increase
- Support at tipping point (SLA breaches, 4-person team)
- Pipeline is $2.1M against $8–10M breakeven threshold

The 3 unknowns that matter most: Can you invest in supply chain first? Is the 14-deal pipeline a leading indicator or a ceiling? What’s the cost of waiting 6 months?

The agent structured the decision without making it. It identified the **unknowns the data can’t answer** — which are the ones that matter most.

Monday Morning Actions

A. Use AI for Your Personal Workflow

The tools from Sessions 1–2 are available now — no IT approval needed. Start with charts, documents, and analyses for your own work.

B. Audit Reporting Workflows

Where do people wait for data? Which recurring reports follow the data → analysis → deliverable pattern and could be automated?

C. Scope a 30-Day Sprint

Pick one team, one data source, 30 days. Build a prototype and test with real questions from real users.

D. Identify Prediction Problems

Identify 2–3 prediction problems in your business — where could classification or regression help? Churn risk, demand forecasting, lead scoring, defect detection.

E. Establish Governance

Who validates AI output? Who approves deployment? Define this before shadow IT does it for you.

You don't need a 12-month roadmap. You need **one pilot, one owner, one deadline.**

The 30-Day Sprint

Week 1

Pick & Prep

Choose one use case. Identify the data source. Get stakeholder buy-in.

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Week 2

Build & Test

Connect the data. Build the prototype. Test with real questions from real users.

→

Week 3

Validate

Compare AI answers to known results. Document accuracy. Identify failure modes.

→

Week 4

Decide

Go/no-go for expanded pilot. Present findings. Define Phase 2 scope.

Resources

Continue Your Learning

- **XYZ Corp environment** — remains available for 90 days after the course
- **Course materials** — all slides, case studies, and demo scripts on the course site
- **Recommended reading** — curated list of papers, vendor evaluations, and case studies
- **Office hours** — monthly drop-in sessions for the next quarter
- **Peer network** — your breakout group is your first call when you hit a wall

Final Takeaway

The companies that win with AI

won’t have the best technology. They’ll have the best questions, answers, and governance.

Now go build something.